VAHID ABRARI

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U.S. immigrant visa issued (EB-1A, October 2026); no sponsorship required; available to relocate

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Civil liability for AI training data and large-scale data exploitation; AI governance and the rule of law; empirical evaluation of AI tools in legal practice, legal education and access to justice; smart-contract enforceability and blockchain regulation; comparative EU and North American digital regulation (AI Act, GDPR, MiCA).

EDUCATION

Sapienza University of Rome — Rome, Italy
Master of Laws (LL.M.) programme, European Law and Economics — 2022 – 2024

- Laurea Magistrale in European Studies (LM-90, taught in English); research on AI, blockchain and contractual liability under EU law; Lazio DiSCo merit scholarship (2022). Studies on hold since 2024; degree not yet conferred.

University of Tehran, Kish International Campus — Kish, Iran
Master of Laws (LL.M.) programme, International Economic and Commercial Law — 2021 – 2022

- Admitted on academic merit without the national entrance examination; top 5% of cohort. Left in 2022 for graduate study in Italy; no degree conferred.

Islamic Azad University, Larestan Branch — Iran
Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.) — 2016 – 2019

Additional Training

- **University of Oxford, Saïd Business School** (with the Blavatnik School of Government, Faculty of Law and UNESCO): AI, Justice, and the Rule of Law, CPD certified (Sept. 2026).
- **HarvardX, Harvard Law School**: HLS2X Contract Law: From Trust to Promise to Contract, Verified Certificate (Oct. 2026).
- **Lund University** (Coursera): AI and Law, with honours; also Legal Tech and the Digital Transformation of Law (Universidad Austral), Privacy Law and Data Protection (University of Pennsylvania) (2023 – 2024).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Independent Research, AI Training-Data Liability — 2025 – 2026

- Comparative study of cross-border civil liability for the commercial use of big data to train AI systems under U.S. and Canadian law, covering copyright, privacy, unjust enrichment and tort theories; accepted for the 25th International Conference on Legal and Judicial Studies, Berlin (Oct. 2026).

Research Assistant, Sapienza University of Rome — Dec. 2022 – Aug. 2024

- Analyzed EU regulatory frameworks for smart contracts, digital assets and AI (MiCA, AI Act, GDPR) and compliance gaps in cross-border digital transactions.
- Presented findings on blockchain and smart-contract law at an international conference in London (2024).

Project Lead, Smart-Contract Framework, JTI "Make It Bright" Challenge — Sept. – Dec. 2021

- Designed a smart-contract framework for commercial and supply-chain agreements, ranked Global Top 10 of 8,000+ submissions (Geneva, 2021) and first in the Iran national round.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- "Cross-Border Civil Liability for the Commercial Exploitation of Big Data: A Comparative Legal Analysis of AI Training-Data Challenges under United States and Canadian Law." 25th Int'l Conf. on Legal and Judicial Studies, Berlin, accepted for presentation and proceedings (Oct. 2026).
- "The Role of Blockchain Technology in the Future of Smart Contracts: A Legal Analysis." 4th Int'l Conf. on Humanities, Educational Sciences, Law and Social Sciences, London (Aug. 2024).
- "Modernizing Iran's Construction Contract System: A Comparative Analysis and Strategic Roadmap" (co-authored). 3rd Int'l Conf. on Applied Research in Civil Engineering, Architecture and Urban Planning, Munich (Dec. 2025).
- "An Analysis of the Concept of 'Safe Port' in International Transport Law with Reference to International Rulings." 10th Int'l Conf. on Legal and Judicial Studies, Budapest (July 2022).

- "Definition of a Foreign Legal Investor under the 'Own' and 'Control' Criteria in International Arbitration." 2nd Int'l Conf. on Humanities, Law, Social Studies and Psychology, Izmir (May 2022).
- Two further papers on criminal immunity and humanitarian law in international law, national conference, Iran (May 2021). Full list on CIVILICA and Google Scholar.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Law Clerk, M. Tabatabaee Immigration Services Inc. Toronto, ON
Full-time litigation support, Federal Court of Canada Feb. 2026 – Present

- Prepare Applications for Leave and Judicial Review and Immigration Appeal Division matters; draft submissions, affidavits and motion materials; conduct legal research informing hearing strategy.
- Introduced document automation and workflow changes in Clio that increased the firm's case capacity; earned the Clio Certified Legal Administrator (CCLA) credential (2026).

Paralegal, Pax Law Corporation North Vancouver, BC
Regulatory and litigation drafting under counsel supervision Sept. 2025 – Jan. 2026

Co-Founder & Managing Director, Dadandishan Melal Barman International Institute Tehran, Iran
Registered non-commercial institute for legal consulting and training July 2021 – Present

- Direct legal and management consulting, commercial-contract advisory and legal training programs; directed remotely since December 2024.

Senior Legal Specialist, Ehya Manabe Ofogh Ayandeh (Ayandeh Bank group) Tehran, Iran
Litigation and debt recovery for a financial-services group May 2022 – Oct. 2022

Earlier roles: Legal Intern, Canyon Entertainment Group, Toronto (licensing and IP, 2025); Legal Intern, JTI via Pars Mabani Co., Tehran (2021); legal expert and consultant roles with Iranian legal institutes (2019 – 2022).

HONORS AND AWARDS

- EB-1A classification as an individual of extraordinary ability, approved by USCIS (April 2024).
- Global Top 10 Finalist (1st in Iran), JTI "Make It Bright" Global Innovation Challenge, 8,000+ submissions (2021).
- First place, national humanitarian-law moot court competitions, Iranian Red Crescent Society; selected for the international round (2020).
- Selected National Elite, National Elite Foundation of Iran (2020); Lazio DiSCo merit scholarship, Sapienza (2022).

TEACHING AND OUTREACH

- Legal-track contributor, CS50x Iran (Harvard's introductory computer science course): data privacy, IP and software ethics (2022).
- Webinars on technology-transfer contracts and comparative civil procedure (2021 – 2022); mentor, JTI "Make It Bright" Iran national round (2021).

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Research: comparative and doctrinal legal research; AI governance and EU digital regulation; Westlaw, HeinOnline; Power BI; Clio and legal document automation.
Languages: Persian (native); English (fluent, C2); French (B2); Italian (A2); Arabic (A2).